Alan Parsons

Technical Director at Craftsman+

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SUMMARY

Solutions architect with a frontend background, building for the web since 2009, from pixel-pushing to system design. I started in design and frontend development and spent over a decade building interfaces and leading frontend teams, so I approach architecture with a strong understanding of what developers need to ship good work. Now I focus on technical architecture, microservices and event-driven systems. TypeScript is my main language, and I've shipped production apps in React, Vue and Svelte.

EXPERIENCE

Mar 2026 – now

Technical Director · Craftsman+

Leading the technical direction and architecture of the company's creative and playable ad platform. Monthly active customer users of its Studio grew by about 40% over the past year.

- Led real-time multiplayer editing for the PLAY editor, shipped in PLAY v5.4: scenes split into per-object records, a sync backend with room permissions, and live cursors, selection and presence.
- Built the AI layer across the platform: model calls routed through Cloudflare AI Gateway and Amazon Bedrock with provider fallback, AI video and asset generation pipelines, and a chat assistant inside the editor that customers have used for over 14,000 requests and 85,000 tool calls since it launched in early 2026.
- Opened the platform to AI agents with an MCP server, OAuth consent flow and delegated tokens, so assistants such as ChatGPT can work inside a company's permissions.
- Designed credit-based usage limits, licences and seat management, with per-user usage tracking and billing.
- Made the platform faster and cheaper to run: lower asset pipeline latency, streamed exports, bounded concurrency and cold-start profiling.

Jan 2022 – Mar 2026

Software Solutions Architect · Craftsman+

Designed the technical architecture: microservices, event-driven systems, TypeScript throughout, on AWS with CI/CD and test-driven development.

- Set up the original serverless platform in 2022: the API, Vue frontend, canvas library and AWS infrastructure as code.
- Built the export pipeline that turns creatives into HTML5 playable ads tailored to each ad network, with direct upload integrations.
- Led and helped implement the playable analytics stack, from in-ad event tracking through ingestion to real-time dashboards of engagement and scene paths. In the year to September 2026 it tracked nearly 3 billion ad sessions and over 110 million click-throughs, with peak months above 450 million sessions.
- Shipped core Studio features, including the asset library, asset optimisation, folders and search, and enterprise single sign-on.

Sep 2011 – Jan 2022

Lead CSS / Frontend Developer · GForces, Maidstone

Over ten years building interfaces and leading the frontend team.

2009 – Sep 2011

Earlier roles

Graphics & Web Designer at SiteWizard.co.uk (May 2010 – Sep 2011) and 1businesssystem (2009 – 2010).

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS
Frameworks	React, Vue, Svelte, Node.js
Architecture	Microservices, event-driven systems, AWS
Delivery	CI/CD, TDD, end-to-end testing, Jira, Confluence

SIDE PROJECTS

Puzzles & Mortar
Free maths and word puzzle game where solved puzzles build a city. puzzlesandmortar.com

Deep Keep
Free tactical roguelite in the browser with no hidden dice. playdeepkeep.com

Grove Bench
Open-source Windows app for running several Claude Code sessions side by side in git worktrees.

Fluid Gallery
Open-source jQuery lightbox plugin, my first public project (2015).

EDUCATION

2006 – 2009

BA Architecture · University for the Creative Arts